Family Centered Care:
A Checklist for Professionals

SETHU
Child Development and Family Guidance

Family-centered care (FCC) is a partnership approach to health care decision-making. FCC is an attitude change in the way clinical care is delivered. FCC ensures that healthcare is planned around the whole family and all members are recognised as care receivers and active decision makers.

The general principles of FCC are:

- Respectful and Supportive Care: A working relationship marked by respect for diversity, cultural and linguistic traditions, and care preferences.
- Partnership and Collaboration: Medically appropriate decisions that best fit the needs, strengths, values, and abilities of the families at the level they choose.
- Information Sharing: General information about community resources, as well as information specific to the child's disability is shared in an open, objective, and unbiased manner.
- Coordinated and Comprehensive Care: Care and decision-making reflect the child within the context of his/her family, home, school, daily activities, and quality of life within the community.

Question	Yes/No
Do you give families options for meeting time and location (e.g., online)?	
Do you ask about and focus on the strengths of the child and family?	
Do you collaborate with families when deciding a suitable plan of care?	
Do you offer families a variety of options and allow them to make choices?	
Do you provide families with information in various ways - written, videos, internet resources?	
Do you ask families what they would like from you and your services?	
Do you have enough time to talk to families at each visit and ensure they don't feel rushed?	
Do you listen to what families tell you? Do you believe and trust them?	
Do you offer families the opportunities to connect with other families?	
Do you ask about families about their support system and who they would like to be involved in the child's care?	

(Adapted from CanChild - Centre for Childhood Disability Research)